England, and you will find committed spectators enjoying Test cricket. Many people predicted the end of roast beef when hamburgers came on the market. Those fears were misplaced because, while the mass market loves the convenience of fast food, a significant core audience still cherishes the real thing.

In my view, Test cricket will continue to be played for many decades to come, played in daylight hours, played with a red ball and played in white clothing. It will continue because it remains the preferred format of a strong group of spectators, whose numbers are not declining and whose passion is not diminishing. I count myself as a member of this audience, and I will be watching Test cricket for many years after I stop playing.

The Australians left for home after a two-Test series, and, strangely, the Sri Lankans then arrived to play a three-Test series. The summer schedule seemed lopsided, but players are not encouraged to worry about such matters. We simply focus on the next match.

We were working ourselves into a dominant position in the first Test at SuperSport Park, and I had moved my score on to 99 when, facing Thisara Perera, I cut the ball firmly towards point where it appeared to be caught by the substitute fielder, Dimuth Karunaratne. I didn't know whether the ball had carried and thought the umpires would call for clarification from their colleague watching a replay upstairs.

Instead umpire Rod Tucker, of Australia, asked me if I wanted a review.

'No,' I replied, 'let's ask the fielder.'

I reckoned we should follow the Jacques Kallis method of dealing with such situations, putting the onus on the fielder to make an honesty call, trusting the 'spirit of cricket' above the technology.

'Did you catch it?'

'Yes,' he replied.

'Are you sure?'

'Yes,' he replied.

Fair enough, I thought. He had no doubts, so I turned and headed